

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Public Law Paralegal role advertised through Gemini Recruitment because my background spans exactly the kind of work a public law practice draws on most: case preparation, procedural document drafting, client-facing advice on complex statutory rules, and managing files across competing deadlines.

At Citizens Advice East Berkshire, where I work as a Legal Adviser, I handle matters involving welfare benefits, housing, employment and debt. In practice, this means assessing eligibility against statutory criteria, identifying evidential gaps, drafting correspondence and applications, and explaining procedural options clearly to clients who are often in difficult circumstances. The statutory and regulatory focus of that work sits close to public law in a meaningful way: I regularly have to interpret legislation, apply it to a client's facts and advise on what the rules actually require. Managing those matters from initial instruction through to submission has also developed the kind of file management and deadline discipline that a busy paralegal role demands.

Before that, I spent a year at BCLP, split between international arbitration and real estate disputes. In the arbitration team, I became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant submission deadline. I coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions across the matter and helped ensure on-time delivery of the Claimant's memorial. I also drafted procedural histories and orders, reviewed and organised evidence, and liaised with an external translator for Romanian documents. In the disputes team, I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and conducted legal and factual research across several matters simultaneously. Both rotations required me to manage large volumes of confidential documents carefully and to communicate clearly with fee earners under pressure.

What draws me to public law specifically is the combination of statutory analysis and real consequences for the individuals or organisations affected. My Citizens Advice work has shown me how much turns on a precise reading of eligibility rules or procedural requirements, and I want to develop that further in a firm setting where public law is a core practice area rather than an incidental part of the work. A Legal 500-recognised firm with a broad public law offering and offices across England and Wales gives me scope to build on what I have already done in a structured environment.

I am available immediately and would welcome the opportunity to discuss the role further.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva